

Minimundo – Aubagne

Answers to your questions of 29 August 2026. Your questions are in blue, our answers in black.

Before the seven points. Aubagne is the first Minimundo. We intend to open the same concept in other cities around the world, and we are already working with you on a first project in Australia, so what we design here is a model we will want to build again. Two things matter to us from the start: a strong identity, and quality that still holds up after several years of heavy use. To be clear about one thing, catalogue products suit us very well when the quality is there. Being able to choose from what you already build well is an advantage for us, not a compromise. If this first park works, we will be back for the next ones, and we are happy to talk early about what that means for both of us.

1. Opening target and reverse schedule

As the target opening is December 2026, the available time for manufacturing, transportation, site preparation, installation, commissioning and final approval is very limited. We would like to discuss the key dates for: final layout approval; quotation and contract confirmation; production start; site readiness and handover for installation; installation window and final inspection before opening.

We are aiming to open on **Wednesday 16 December 2026**, three days before the French Christmas school holidays begin.

Counting backwards from that date, with 6 to 7 weeks of sea freight to Fos-sur-Mer including customs and inland delivery, 3 weeks of installation and about 10 days of inspections, we arrive at this schedule:

- **18 September:** final layout approved, quotation confirmed, contract signed, deposit paid
- **21 September:** production starts, factory slot and freight booking confirmed, visa applications launched the same week
- **2 October:** document file sent to us (test reports, material certificates, manuals)
- **10 October:** first container leaves the factory, the following ones staged, the last one by 30 October
- **15 October:** go or no go. If the first container has not shipped, we move the opening to 20 February 2027
- **13 November:** site ready and handed over to you, with a finished and dry floor, electrical supply points in each zone, general lighting installed, HVAC running, sprinklers and fire systems installed and tested, truck access, a storage room and access equipment
- **18 November to 4 December:** installation
- **7 to 11 December:** snagging, initial electrical and playground inspections by an approved body, safety commission visit and opening authorisation
- **16 December:** opening

The layout freeze on 18 September is the date that drives all the others. After it, a change costs time rather than money, and time is what we are short of.

What we would like from you on this point: your real production lead time for this volume; whether you can hold a factory slot now against a letter of intent; a commitment on the date the first container leaves; and staged shipments loaded in the order we will install them, with a packing list per container. A price for rail from China to Europe, or for air freight on part of the goods, would also be useful to have as a backup.

2. Site conditions, facilities rooms and common areas

We understand that the reception, bar, birthday rooms, changing area, restrooms, shop and storage locations are fixed. To design the overall visitor flow correctly, we would like to understand: your planned operating model and customer journey; how the reception, bar, shop and birthday rooms will be used in daily operation; whether any of these fixed areas require our design, furniture, visual treatment or equipment scope.

Operating model. Our core target is families with children from 1 to 10 years old. We plan two-hour timed sessions at peak times (Wednesday, weekends and school holidays) with 3 to 4 rotations a day, and free flow off peak. Three sources of revenue: family admissions, birthday parties, and groups such as schools, holiday centres, company events and private evening hire.

Customer journey. Entrance and queuing area, then reception and ticketing, then the cloakroom with lockers and non-slip socks. A short transition leads to the central square, where the whole city should be visible at once. Children then roam freely through the streets, with animations at fixed times to give the city its rhythm. The parents' bar looks onto the square and the action zone. Given the layout of the building, visitors will cross the play hall to reach the birthday rooms, and that is acceptable to us. Visitors leave through the shop. The restrooms and the baby-changing area can be reached from the city without going back through reception.

Scope on these areas. To answer your question directly: yes, we would like all of them in your scope. Reception, bar, shop, birthday rooms, cloakroom and lockers, restroom decoration, wayfinding signage and the storage areas. We want one design hand and one visual world across the whole venue, so please include design, furniture, visual treatment and equipment for these spaces.

The final connections, meaning water, waste, electrical supply and ventilation, will be carried out by our French companies. Please send us your technical drawings and your supply point requirements early so they can be prepared.

Please price each of these areas on its own line, exactly as for the themed spaces, so that we can arbitrate space by space without reopening the whole package.

One constraint for your layout: sightlines. From the bar and from a single supervision point, our staff must be able to see the square, the entrance to the action zone and the slide exits.

3. Height restrictions, HVAC and emergency exits

We would like to clarify the following site constraints before starting the layout: final positions of HVAC, sprinklers, lighting, smoke detectors and other MEP services — will these be subject to our design? Required safety-clearance distances around each emergency exit and the applicable local requirements.

HVAC, sprinklers, fire detection, smoke extraction and emergency lighting are designed and installed by our French architect and engineering office. They are not in your scope and their positions cannot be moved, so the layout has to work around them.

We will send you DWG drawings of the building, the services layout with dimensions, the clear heights under the beams and under the sprinkler heads, the exit positions and escape routes, and the slab constraints. Within a week of layout V1 we would need from you the 3D envelopes in a format our engineers can use, the finished heights, the distributed and point loads, the anchoring positions and forces, and the electrical demand of each zone with its connection points.

The rules to design against:

- 0.50 m left clear below all sprinkler heads.

- Any raised level, platform or roof has to let sprinkler water through, so nets or open grids rather than solid surfaces. If we apply that everywhere from the start, the subject never comes back at us, either from the control office or from our insurer.
- Nothing may sit in front of emergency lighting, smoke detectors, alarm sounders, extinguishers or smoke vent controls, and no suspended element without checking with us first.
- Escape routes keep their full width along the whole path, and the area in front of each emergency exit stays clear over at least 1 m and the full width of the door. No dead end that cannot be supervised.
- The exact clearances and travel distances depend on our final ERP classification and on the occupancy figure. Our control office will give them to us as firm numbers before the layout freeze, and we will pass them straight on to you.
- Accessibility: continuous circulation, turning areas, thresholds and counter heights, following the dimensions we will send.

On height, the 5 m is a gross figure. Once the sprinkler clearance is taken off we expect 4.20 to 4.50 m genuinely usable, so please design on that and confirm it with us before the freeze. We are not planning a full ceiling treatment, but we would like to use the volume visually, with decoration and signage placed high up so that you feel the height as soon as you walk in.

On noise, we are not asking for a dedicated acoustic treatment. We would simply like the materials to be chosen so that the sound level stays reasonable for the parents.

4. Miniature-city design direction

We understand that the project should feel like a real, connected miniature city rather than a row of separate modules. We would like to align on: the priority themed spaces and any themes you would prefer to include or exclude; the required balance between role-play, interactive games, integrated physical/soft play and free exploration; your expectations for façade detail, props, interactive elements, lighting, backlit signage and decorative street details; the desired level of material quality, durability and maintenance requirements.

The principle. We are after a city plan rather than a list of modules. A central square that is the heart of the venue and the natural meeting point, two or three streets running off it, terraced façades with an apparent upper floor and lit windows, pavements and pedestrian crossings marked on the floor, street furniture such as lamp posts, benches, a letterbox, a traffic light, a kiosk and trees, backlit street signs and house numbers, decoration in the upper part of the volume, and ambient sound that changes from one district to the next. The circulation forms a loop, so children move through the city instead of queuing in front of stands, and each trade has a shopfront on the street as well as an interior.

Priority spaces. A supermarket or market, which is the most played space everywhere and should be generously sized. A fire station with its truck. A veterinary clinic. A kitchen, bakery and pizzeria. A construction site, connected to the action zone. A garage, service station and vehicle circuit. A TV studio and stage. A hair and beauty salon. A post office and bank. A creative workshop and school as the quiet corner. A farm with a garden and recycling. A station or an airport. And a separate area for the youngest children, visible from the bar.

That list is where we are starting from, not a specification. You build these parks every day and you know far better than we do what really works with children, so please come with your own ideas. If there are themed spaces you are particularly proud of, ones that have worked beautifully elsewhere, show them to us and we will happily build the city around them. We would much rather use what you already do best than have you reinvent everything for us.

Balance of floor area. Role play 45 to 50%, action and physical play 20 to 25%, interactive 10%, and free exploration, toddlers and circulation for the rest.

Level of detail. High. The façades, the props, the backlit signage, the lighting and the street details are what turn themed spaces into a city, and that is where we want the effort to go.

Quality. This is where we want to be demanding, and we would rather rely on your best standard than write a specification for you: commercial grade, built for intensive daily use, and still looking good after several years. Catalogue products are welcome wherever they meet that level. Please bring material samples with you, and photographs of installations that are a few years old rather than photographs taken at the factory.

One last expectation, which comes from Aubagne being the first site. We would like the design to be documented and reproducible, with drawings, material and colour references and print files organised so that the identity can be rebuilt or adapted city by city instead of being reinvented each time.

5. Action zone and capacity

For the action zone, including illuminated slides, construction/excavation play, ball-pit activities and a ninja course, we would like to confirm: target age groups; expected peak capacity; whether you prefer one concentrated action zone or several distributed elements, because the height (5 m) will be the main effect for the action zone; any priority equipment or experience that must be included.

Age groups. Our core target is families with children from 1 to 10 years old. Rather than impose a breakdown, we would like to see what you propose in terms of age zoning, with a distinct and protected area for the youngest.

Capacity. We are sizing the venue for a peak of 250 to 300 children. The action zone should absorb 25 to 30% of the children present at that peak, so roughly 75 to 90 users at the same time, supervised by two staff from one point with full visibility. Please confirm the capacity and the hourly throughput of each element.

One concentrated zone. We would rather have a single action zone than elements spread around the venue. It is easier to supervise and it gives the space a clear centre of energy, and it is also where the available height should be used.

Equipment we have in mind. An LED tube slide from the top level and a wide racing slide with two or three lanes. A ninja course including an obstacle that pushes children off the wall, with no timer and no scoring, because we want play rather than competition. The construction and excavation zone with excavators and a crane. A ball pit arena with cannons, with a practical way of cleaning and recovering the balls. And low-height climbing. Here again, if you have something better that children love, we are listening.

6. French compliance and documentation

To prepare the correct technical and commercial proposal, we would like to clarify: the respective responsibilities of your architect, local consultants and the supplier for French ERP, PV, fire safety, accessibility and final approval; which EN, CE and test reports are required from your side; which certificates or documents must be issued locally in France; material, flooring, cleaning and maintenance requirements for daily operation.

How the split works. The French regulatory file is ours. Classification and occupancy, the works authorisation and safety notice, fire safety systems, smoke extraction, emergency lighting, accessibility, the initial electrical and playground inspections, the safety commission visit and the opening authorisation, the safety register, the maintenance plan, staff training and our insurance. Our architect, our engineering office,

our control office and the town hall handle all of that. You do not have to carry that file and we are not asking you to become experts in French regulation.

What we do need from you is the product documentation that lets our control office and the safety commission sign off. We are not expecting anything exotic here and we do not want to make this subject heavier than it is. It is simply the last gate before we are allowed to open, so we would like to look at it early and calmly, together.

The easiest way to start is for you to tell us what you already provide to your European customers: which laboratory you work with, which standards you test against, and one or two sample reports if you can. Our control office can go through them in a few days and tell us what works as it stands and what, if anything, we should complete on our side. Doing that in September is easy. Doing it in November would not be.

What we have on our list at this stage, for discussion:

- Test reports against EN 1176 and EN 1177 from a recognised third-party laboratory, ideally referenced to our own equipment, with the free fall heights and safety zones shown on drawings.
- Fire behaviour classification for the materials that matter most: foams, PVC and leatherette coverings, nets, floor coverings, decorative panels and suspended elements. In France this is read through EN 13501-1. If your usual reports follow a different route, send them over and we will have them checked. If something is missing, a material can also be tested here, as long as we know early enough.
- CE declarations for electrical products and for any machinery such as motorised vehicles or excavators.
- The usual statements for the materials children touch: EN 71-3, REACH, and the formaldehyde class of the panels.
- A structural calculation and an anchoring plan for the main structures and for anything suspended.
- A handover file with as-built drawings, electrical schematics, operating and maintenance manuals, a spare parts list, the print files for the decoration, and cleaning instructions per material.
- Your product liability insurance certificate.

On language, manuals in French would help us and we will ask whether that is possible for you. If it is difficult, English is fine and we will have them translated here. The one thing we would like is for the document file to be complete before the goods ship, so that nobody is chasing paperwork during installation.

Issued locally in France, by us: the works authorisation and safety notice, the initial electrical and playground verification reports, the accessibility attestation, the safety commission report and the opening order, and the safety register.

Daily operation. What matters most to us is that the surfaces are easy to clean, and that we receive a clear maintenance plan with the inspection frequencies so we can train our staff on it.

Installation. We want your own installers on site in France, and we want them leading the installation. Nobody knows your products better, and the first Minimundo has to be assembled exactly as you intended it. We will provide a local team to work alongside them for handling, unpacking, logistics and general labour, together with the site facilities, access equipment, storage and waste removal.

Everything that belongs to the building stays with our French companies: sprinklers and fire systems, plumbing, and the main electrical installation up to the supply points in each zone. Your team connects the equipment from there, with a French electrician alongside for the final connection and the certification.

On the practical side, if your technicians travel to France, Schengen visas take four to eight weeks and should be started as soon as we sign, and there are posted-worker formalities to file before they arrive. Tell

us how you usually handle this for European projects and we will prepare it with you. In the quotation, please say how many of your own people you plan to send and for how many days.

7. Quotation scope

Finally, we would like to confirm the required quotation format: separate pricing by themed space; manufacturing, delivery to Aubagne, on-site installation and optional items; payment terms, warranty expectations, spare parts and after-sales support.

Format. An Excel file, or any other format that is easy to read, with one line per item: reference, themed space, description, photo, dimensions, materials, quantity, unit price, total, weight, volume, lead time, target age and capacity. A single total would not let us arbitrate or adjust the scope, which we may well need to do.

- **A. Design fees.** 2D, 3D and technical drawings. Please say whether they are deducted from the order. Ownership of the drawings comes to us.
- **B. Manufacturing.** Priced separately for each themed space and for each facility area (reception, bar, shop, birthday rooms, cloakroom, restrooms, storage, signage). This line-by-line breakdown is the important one for us.
- **C. Packing.** Marked by zone and by installation sequence, with a packing list per container, so that we unload in the right order.
- **D. Freight.** Please quote both FOB and DAP Aubagne unloaded, and tell us which you would recommend. You can organise the shipping, or we can handle it with our own forwarder, since we are 30 km from the port of Marseille. Customs duties and import VAT shown separately.
- **E. Installation.** The number of your own technicians and the number of days on site, and what is included: tools, consumables, flights, accommodation, visas and per diem. Our local support team, the site facilities, access equipment, storage and waste removal are on us.
- **F. Options.** Each on its own line, including anything you would suggest as an addition or for a later phase.
- **G. Spare parts.** A spare parts kit delivered with the park, with the list and the prices.

Payment terms. Please tell us what you propose and we will work from there.

Warranty and after-sales. Likewise, tell us what you offer: how long on the structures, the decoration, the soft parts and the electronics, how long spare parts stay available, and how you handle after-sales support for a site in Europe.

Repeat orders. As Aubagne is meant to be the first of several sites, please also tell us how long your prices stay valid and what conditions you could offer on repeat orders of the same equipment.